

A SHORT GUIDE TO THIS DRAFT

Built to help cold reviewers see what TCU Stats is, why climate leads, and how to review it fast.

WHAT YOU ARE ABOUT TO SEE

ONE CLIMATE STORY. THREE LINKED SYSTEMS.

CORE IDEA

Soil carbon loss drives warming

Warming raises financial stress

Warming destabilizes water

Soil health is the leverage point that changes all three.

PRIMARY GOAL

Clarify the thesis

Position TEI as a scientific authority on soil, climate, resilience, and food-system stability.

REVIEW MODE

Near-final draft

Strong enough for review, with room to tighten messaging and evidence where needed.

BEST USE

Start here first

Use this guide to frame the site before reviewing the details.

REVIEW TIME

10 to 30 minutes

A fast scan takes about 10; a fuller pass takes 20 to 30.

REVIEW PATH

Overview to Water

Overview, Carbon, Economics, then Water.

SUPPORT LAYER

Fact-check synced

Use the fact-check register when any number needs sourcing.

PROJECT FRAMING

WHAT THIS IS

A climate-led review asset for testing the strongest science and messaging behind a food-system resilience story before this becomes a public site, pitch, or media tool.

WHO BUILT THIS

The Edison Institute joins **The Carbon Underground** with **CSU Chico's Center for Regenerative Agriculture and Resilient Systems**.

WHAT THIS IS NOT

Not the final public launch, investor deck, or white paper. It is the shared base those downstream assets will build from.

HOW TO REVIEW THE SITE

START HERE

Overview

Start with the climate throughline, core metrics, and the SOM slider. This sets the logic for everything else, including the food-system stakes.

PILLAR 1

Carbon

See how soil carbon loss became an atmospheric problem and why rebuilding soil carbon matters as drawdown.

PILLAR 2

Economics

See how climate risk is already showing up in the farm ledger through inputs, margins, and debt stress.

PILLAR 3

Water

See how warming appears through water systems: infiltration, aquifer drawdown, and SGMA pressure.

WHAT REVIEWERS SHOULD FOCUS ON

- Is the **purpose clear** right away?
- Does **climate connect** carbon, economics, and water clearly enough to support the food-system stakes?
- Which **proof points** feel strongest?

TIME

Plan on 20 to 30 minutes for a full read. A fast scan should take about 10 minutes.

BEST COMPANION

If a number feels uncertain, cross-check it against the fact-check

WHERE THIS WORK GOES NEXT

The same evidence base can be adapted into downstream assets once the climate framing and strongest proof points are approved.

WHY THIS EXISTS

This is not just a website draft. It is a **shared evidence and messaging foundation**. The goal is to pressure-test the climate story, align on the strongest numbers, and adapt the material into donor tools, public science assets, site architecture, and food-system resilience storytelling.

WHAT APPROVAL SHOULD ANSWER

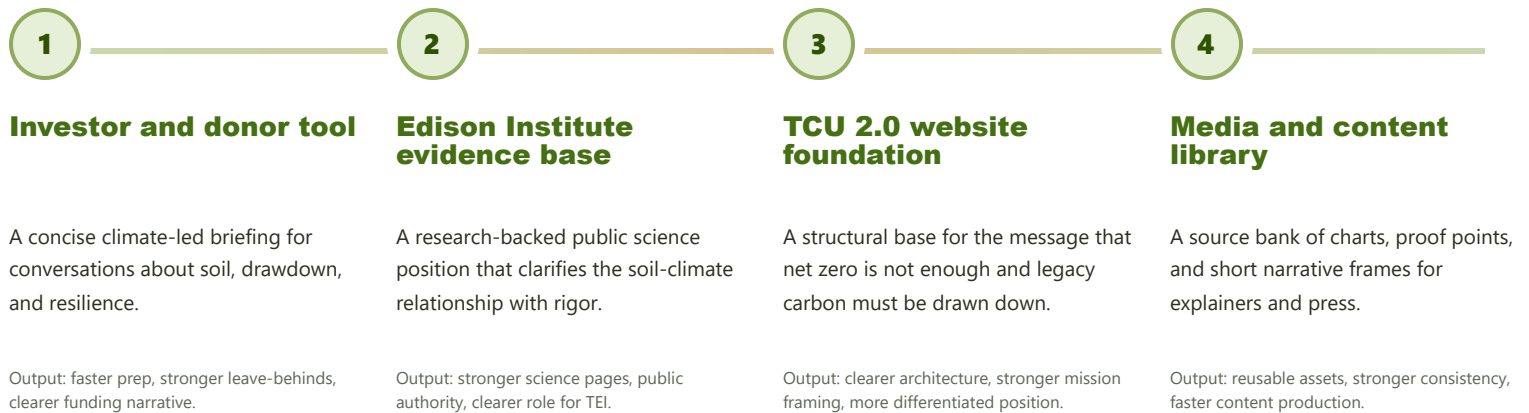
Is the climate throughline strong enough to lead each section?

Do the headline claims feel persuasive and supportable?

Is the purpose obvious within the first screen?

Does TEI feel positioned as a scientific authority?

ROADMAP



WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

MESSAGE CLARITY

A cold reader should understand what TCU Stats is, why it matters, and how climate pressure becomes carbon, economic, water, and food-system risk.

EVIDENCE CONFIDENCE

The strongest public-facing numbers should feel credible, easy to trace, and consistent with the fact-check register.

STRATEGIC REUSE

The material should feel ready to become a meeting tool, public science asset, website structure, and media library.

NEXT MOVE

1. Review the live site.
2. Flag any weak claim or section.
3. Resolve those items in the fact-check register.
4. Reuse the approved material downstream.

SUGGESTED PROMPTS

PURPOSE

If this landed cold in an inbox, would the recipient understand what they are being asked to review, why it matters, and why the food-system stakes are real?

CLIMATE FRAMING

Does each major section reinforce that carbon, economics, and water are connected expressions of the same climate problem, with food security as the consequence?

WEAK POINTS

Which claims, transitions, or sections still feel overstated, under-supported, or too subtle?